



WIKIMEDIA COMMUNITY KILIMANJARO

STRATEGIC PLAN 2026 – 2027

Expanding Knowledge. Empowering Communities.

Kilimanjaro Tanzania

Wikimedia Movement | East Africa

About the Organization

Wikimedia Community Kilimanjaro is a Wikimedia user group based in the Kilimanjaro Tanzania. As part of the global Wikimedia movement, the community mobilizes and organizes a new generation of volunteers who are passionate about Free Knowledge, enabling their meaningful engagement in the Wikimedia community.

The community's primary focus is on growing English Wikipedia (enwiki) and Swahili Wikipedia (swwiki), with a deliberate commitment to shrinking the gender gap on Wikipedia and on the internet at large. The community has been actively involved in edit-a-thons, photowalks, training new editors, Movement Strategy discussions, Wikimania, and WikiIndaba and plans to continue leveraging these activities to contribute to the growth of Wikimedia projects in the Kilimanjaro region.

Wikimedia Community Kilimanjaro is also committed to leveraging collaboration with communities within Tanzania and the broader East Africa region, as well as the global Wikimedia movement, to achieve its goals in line with the Wikimedia Movement Strategy 2030.

Mission Statement

Our Mission

To engage and equip volunteers in the Kilimanjaro region with the skills, tools, and resources needed to create, improve, and disseminate free knowledge on Wikimedia projects with a particular focus on English and Swahili Wikipedia while fostering inclusive and gender-equitable participation across the Wikimedia movement.

Vision Statement

Our Vision

A knowledgeable, digitally empowered Kilimanjaro community where every individual regardless of gender, background, or location can freely access, contribute to, and benefit from the world's knowledge through Wikimedia projects, and where local knowledge is represented, preserved, and shared globally.

Guiding Principles

Free Knowledge for All

We are committed to making knowledge freely accessible to every person, in every language with particular emphasis on English and Swahili as a core expression of the Wikimedia mission.

Gender Equity

We actively work to reduce the digital gender gap by creating safe, supportive spaces for women and underrepresented communities to contribute to and lead Wikimedia projects.

Community-Centered Approach

Our programs are built with and for our community. We value the voices, experiences, and knowledge of volunteers, partners, and participants in everything we do.

Quality and Accuracy

We uphold high standards of content quality, accuracy, and neutrality, collaborating with subject-matter experts and experienced editors to ensure Wikipedia articles are reliable and relevant.

Collaboration and Partnership

We believe in the power of collaboration with local communities, regional affiliates, educational institutions, and the global Wikimedia movement as a multiplier for impact and sustainability.

Transparency and Accountability

We operate openly, sharing our plans, results, and challenges publicly, and use our resources responsibly to maximize impact on our mission and the Wikimedia movement.

Challenges We Are Addressing

Our strategic plan is shaped by a clear understanding of the key challenges facing our community and the broader Wikimedia movement in Tanzania:

- Limited quality Swahili and locally relevant Wikipedia content: Many articles lack accuracy, completeness, or local cultural context.
- Gender gap in participation: Women remain significantly underrepresented as contributors and leaders within Wikimedia projects and on the internet at large.
- Limited volunteer skills and internal capacity: Volunteers need structured training in editing, leadership, event management, and inter-community collaboration.
- Low awareness and digital literacy: Many potential contributors particularly students and teachers are unaware of Wikimedia projects or lack the skills to participate.
- Fragmented community collaboration: Insufficient coordination between volunteers and communities reduces the efficiency and sustainability of Wikimedia activities.
- Volunteer recognition and motivation: Without visible acknowledgment and professional development pathways, sustaining long-term volunteer engagement is challenging.

Strategic Objectives

Objective 1: Community Growth and Representation

To grow the Wikimedia Community in Kilimanjaro, provide structure, and ensure community representation in decision-making within the Wikimedia movement. We will recruit new volunteers, establish clear community governance, and actively participate in movement-level discussions and conferences.

Objective 2: Promoting Wikimedia Projects and Free Knowledge

To promote Wikimedia projects and free knowledge in general, and to encourage the use of Wikimedia resources in community empowerment. We will organize public events, outreach campaigns, and school programs that demonstrate the value of Wikipedia and related platforms.

Objective 3: Regional and Global Collaboration

To synergize and collaborate with other affiliates regionally and globally in implementing the Wikimedia Movement Strategy 2030. We will actively engage with Tanzanian communities, East African affiliates, and global Wikimedia networks to advance shared goals.

Objective 4: Capacity Building

To invest in the capacity building of community members. We will provide structured training in Wikipedia editing, Wikidata, Wikimedia Commons, leadership, event planning, and documentation, building a skilled and self-sustaining volunteer base.

Objective 5: Events, Workshops, and Contests

To organize conventions, edit-a-thons, workshops, photowalks, and contests in line with the Wikimedia movement's vision, engaging both experienced contributors and newcomers in meaningful collaborative activities.

Objective 6: Recruit and Train Newcomers

To train and recruit newcomers from the Kilimanjaro region, with a focus on youth, students, and educators. We will design beginner-friendly onboarding programs and peer mentorship systems to lower barriers to participation.

Objective 7: Shrink the Digital Gender Gap

To actively work toward gender equality in digital knowledge creation. Through dedicated programs such as Wikimalkia and Feminism and Folklore Tanzania, we will mentor women contributors, promote their leadership, and recognize their impact within the Wikimedia community.

Programs 2026–2027

Our 2026–2027 program builds on established foundations while placing stronger emphasis on quality content creation, gender equity, internal capacity building, and community collaboration. Below is a summary of all programs planned for this period:

Program	Sessions/Year	Description
Monthly Edit-thon	5 sessions	Regular editing sessions for existing and new contributors, with training on Wikidata, Wikimedia Commons, and guided editing support.
WikiHealth	2 events	Improves health-related Wikipedia content in collaboration with health professionals, combined with community outreach including basic eye examinations.
Wikimalkia (WikiQueens)	5 sessions	Dedicated program for women contributors focused on mentorship, leadership development, and reducing the gender gap in Wikimedia projects.
Feminism & Folklore TZ	Campaign	Documents Tanzanian feminism and folklore through edit-a-thons, photo walks, and writing activities, engaging women and local communities.
Let's Connect	2 events	Internal capacity building through training in Wikipedia, Wikidata, leadership, event management, and collaboration with other Wikimedia communities.
Community Gathering	1 event	Annual celebration to strengthen community bonds, recognize outstanding volunteers, share

		experiences, and plan future collaborative initiatives.
Kiwix for Schools	10 activities	Provides offline Wikipedia access and training for teachers and students in 10 new schools, building digital literacy and encouraging contributions.
Error and Fix Campaign	4 events	Collaborative campaign to identify, fact-check, and correct errors in existing Wikipedia articles, improving quality and training volunteers.

Program Descriptions

1. Monthly Edit-thon (5 sessions per year)

The Monthly Edit-thon is our flagship activity, providing a structured, regular space where both experienced and new participants actively edit, learn, and grow. Each session includes practical training on tools such as Wikidata and Wikimedia Commons, onboarding for newcomers, and guided editing support. Beyond technical skills, these sessions are designed to motivate participants, encourage peer learning, and build a supportive environment for community development.

2. WikiHealth (2 events per year)

WikiHealth brings together volunteers, experienced editors, and health professionals to address gaps in health-related Wikipedia articles, ensuring accuracy and local relevance. In addition to improving online knowledge, the program includes a direct community outreach component: health professionals conduct basic eye examinations, provide glasses to those in need, and offer general health guidance connecting online knowledge improvement with real-world community impact.

3. Wikimalkia WikiQueens (5 sessions per year)

Launched to create a dedicated, empowering space for women in our community, Wikimalkia directly addresses the gender gap in Wikimedia projects. Building on prior impact including one participant

being recognized as a NOSS Ambassador under Africa Wiki Women the program continues to expand through mentorship, leadership development, and networking opportunities that empower women to grow as confident contributors and community leaders.

4. Feminism and Folklore Tanzania

This campaign documents Tanzanian feminism and folklore through edit-a-thons, photo walks, and collaborative writing activities. It engages women contributors and local communities to capture and preserve indigenous knowledge, cultural traditions, and the stories of women pioneers ensuring this heritage is represented on Wikipedia and Wikimedia Commons for future generations.

5. Let's Connect (2 events per year)

Let's Connect focuses on internal capacity building, addressing gaps in essential skills needed to effectively contribute to and manage Wikimedia projects. Activities include collaborating with Wikimedians of Arusha on strategic planning, receiving training from Jenga Wikipedia on Wiktionary contributions, and training volunteers on event planning, use of the Programs and Events Dashboard, and documentation. The program also positions Wikimedia Kilimanjaro as a mentor to emerging communities in the region.

6. Community Gathering (1 event per year)

The annual Community Gathering strengthens relationships, builds cohesion, and celebrates the achievements of the Kilimanjaro Wikimedia community. It provides a space for volunteers to share experiences, exchange knowledge, and reflect on progress. Outstanding contributors are recognized and celebrated, and the event serves as a platform for community planning and strategic reflection.

7. Kiwix for Schools (10 activities per year)

Building on the previous year's partnership with RENEAL Outreach Education in which teachers and students in 10 schools were trained to use Wikipedia as a trusted academic resource this program expands offline Wikipedia access to an additional 10 schools. The program fosters digital literacy, research skills, and active participation in Wikimedia, while also encouraging students and teachers to contribute directly to Wikipedia.

8. Error and Fix Campaign (4 events per year)

This campaign focuses on improving the quality and reliability of Wikipedia content by identifying and correcting errors in existing articles. Volunteers work together to review, fact-check, and update content with proper referencing, while also developing their own editing and research skills. The campaign reinforces a culture of quality and accountability within our community.

Key Activities

In addition to our structured programs, Wikimedia Community Kilimanjaro will be engaged in the following key activities during 2026–2027:

1. Organizing thematic Wikimedia projects including edit-a-thons, workshops, and photowalks across the Kilimanjaro region.
2. Training youth in Kilimanjaro on how to contribute to Wikipedia and champion free knowledge.
3. Advancing the growth of Swahili Wikipedia through focused content creation and quality improvement.
4. Media relations and press coverage for community events to increase public awareness of Wikimedia projects.
5. Creating partnerships with like-minded communities and organizations in Tanzania and East Africa.
6. Collaboration with regional and global communities to advance the Wikimedia Movement Strategy 2030.

Approaches

Capacity Building

Structured training and mentorship are provided through Let's Connect, Monthly Edit-thons, and WikiHealth, equipping volunteers with skills in editing, leadership, resource management, and inter-community collaboration.

Gender Equity

Programs including Wikimalkia and Feminism and Folklore Tanzania actively empower women contributors and promote inclusive participation at all levels of the community, directly targeting the digital gender gap.

Community Engagement and Collaboration

Regular events such as Monthly Edit-thons, Community Gatherings, and Kiwix for Schools strengthen volunteer networks and public participation. Partnerships with schools, universities, cultural institutions, and professional organizations expand our impact and knowledge-sharing capacity.

Sustainability and Quality

By training new leaders, systematically documenting activities, mentoring emerging communities, and maintaining strong quality standards in content creation, we are building a community that is resilient, impactful, and able to sustain Wikimedia activities beyond any single project cycle.

Challenges and Strategies

Challenge	Why It Matters	Strategy
Limited quality Swahili & local content	Many articles lack accuracy, completeness, or local relevance.	Host Monthly Edit-thons and WikiHealth events to create, edit, and verify content with experienced editors and professionals.
Gender gap in participation	Women are underrepresented as contributors and leaders.	Expand Wikimalkia and Feminism & Folklore programs to mentor, train, and recognize women contributors and leaders.

Limited volunteer skills & capacity	Volunteers need essential skills to contribute effectively.	Use Let's Connect for internal capacity building in editing, leadership, resource management, and peer mentorship.
Fragmented collaboration	Lack of coordination reduces efficiency and impact.	Organize Community Gatherings and Let's Connect to strengthen relationships and plan joint initiatives with other communities.
Low awareness & digital literacy	Many potential contributors are unaware of Wikimedia or lack skills.	Conduct outreach through Kiwix for Schools, public events, and campaigns to train students, teachers, and volunteers.
Volunteer recognition & retention	Without acknowledgment and development, sustaining engagement is hard.	Recognize contributions at Community Gatherings; support top volunteers to attend WikiIndaba or Wikimania.

Annual Goals 2026–2027

Wikimedia Community Kilimanjaro will pursue the following measurable goals during the 2026–2027 project year:

- Increase the number of Swahili and English Wikipedia articles through new creation and quality improvement.
- Grow the number of active contributors by at least 15% compared to the prior year.

- Conduct all 8 planned programs: 5 Edit-thons, 2 WikiHealth events, 5 Wikimalkia sessions, 2 Let's Connect events, 1 Community Gathering, 4 Error & Fix campaigns, and 10 Kiwix for Schools activities.
- Reach at least 200 new individuals through outreach, training, and Kiwix for Schools.
- Expand the Kiwix for Schools program to 10 new schools in the Kilimanjaro region.
- Increase women's representation in active editing and community leadership roles.
- Collaborate with at least 2 new partner institutions schools, universities, or organizations.
- Support 1–2 top volunteers to attend an international Wikimedia conference (WikiIndaba or Wikimania).
- Document all activities systematically using the Programs and Events Dashboard.

Monitoring and Evaluation

Wikimedia Community Kilimanjaro will track the following key indicators to assess progress and ensure accountability:

- Growth in the number of new and improved articles on Swahili and English Wikipedia.
- Count of active contributors on Wikipedia and related Wikimedia projects.
- Number of new participants trained and onboarded across all programs.
- Women's representation among active contributors and in leadership roles.
- Number of schools reached through the Kiwix for Schools program.
- Number of events, edit-a-thons, and workshops organized and documented.
- Social media reach, including followers and engagement levels.
- Number of multimedia files contributed to Wikimedia Commons.
- Participant and partner satisfaction from post-event surveys.
- Number of new inter-community collaborations and partnerships established.

We will use the Programs and Events Dashboard to record metrics and share regular reports with the Wikimedia community through Meta-Wiki, ensuring transparency and continuous learning.

Organizational Sustainability

Leadership Development

By investing in future organizers and leaders through Let's Connect and mentorship, we reduce over-reliance on any single individual and ensure the continuity of community activities.

Knowledge Transfer

Systematic documentation of activities, lessons learned, and best practices ensures that institutional knowledge is preserved and transferable, enabling new community members to build on what has been achieved.

Partnerships for Long-term Impact

Embedding Wikimedia activities within schools, universities, and partner organizations creates lasting structures that support volunteer recruitment, retention, and community growth.

Regional Collaboration

By working with Wikimedians of Arusha, Jenga Wikipedia, and other East African Wikimedia communities, we strengthen the broader regional movement and create mutual support networks that benefit all affiliates.

Conclusion

Wikimedia Community Kilimanjaro's Strategic Plan for 2026–2027 reflects our commitment to expanding free knowledge in Tanzania, closing the gender gap in digital knowledge creation, and building a skilled, inclusive, and resilient volunteer community aligned with the Wikimedia Movement Strategy 2030.

By deepening our proven programs, building new partnerships, and empowering the next generation of Wikimedia contributors in Kilimanjaro, we aim to make a lasting contribution to the global Wikimedia movement and ensure that knowledge is free, accessible, and representative of every community in Tanzania and beyond.



Wikimedia Community Kilimanjaro

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